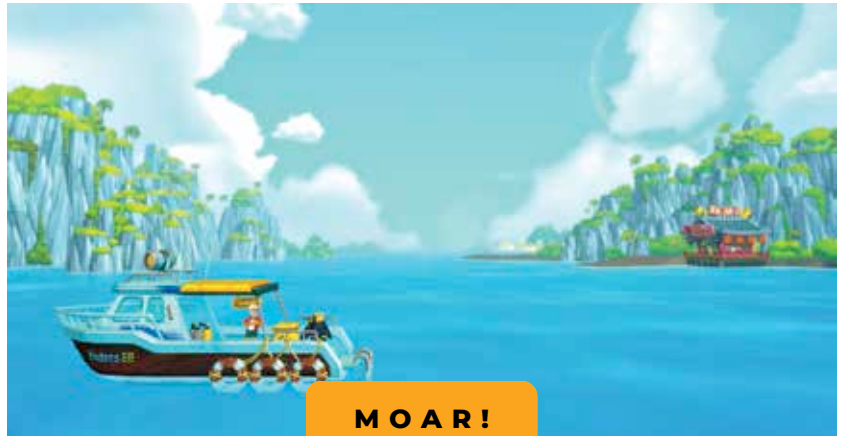


soft rays of sunlight filtering through the water surface create a picturesque setting for whatever unfolds in the game's linear storyline.

The protagonist, Dave, is a quirky and affable diver with a can-do and never-say-die attitude, albeit a begrudging one. The supporting cast surrounding him, Bancho – the no-nonsense chef and owner of the sushi restaurant – and Cobra, the shady investor who gets Dave into his current predicament, complement Dave quite well in bringing the initial gaming experience to life. As the game goes on, Dave obviously meets more NPCs that play a critical role in the overall game's narrative arc, but ultimately the buck stops at our diligent yet out-of-shape diver. His animated expressions and reluctant humour adds a personal touch to the underwater exploration saga that is key to keeping you hooked till the very end. The game's overall storytelling isn't bad either, as it keeps unravelling a new layer when you least expect it. The mysterious lore surrounding ancient underwater ruins and the legends of hidden treasures keeps Dave's adventures thrilling and engaging till the last minute.

In terms of the overall game mechanics and gameplay in general, Dave the Diver's interactive elements complemented the exploratory nature of the story's narrative. The quests are nicely detailed, with various puzzles cleverly integrated, creating a challenging experience to engage the mind but not too difficult to hinder progress. The educational snippets about marine life, and how the various underwater flora and fauna behave isn't too dissimilar from what you'd find on Wikipedia, for instance. The whispers and echoes of a lost ancient marine civilization adds more drama to Dave the Diver, aspects of the game that are anecdotally satisfying.

On the technical front, the game performed seamlessly with minimal bugs. The sound design, for me, was the highlight of Dave the Diver's experience. The calming tunes of the



MOAR!

PUBLISHER
Mintrocket

DEVELOPER
Mintrocket

PLATFORM
Windows, MacOS,
Nintendo Switch
(Tested on PC)

PRICE
₹880

ocean contrast well with the tense, eerie music that plays while approaching a dangerous underwater creature or a mysterious passage – it stitches the whole vibe together seamlessly.

Is it repetitive and boring? Yes, without a doubt. The constant diving for fish, putting together a menu, managing the restaurant at night, growing your own crops, etc – all of it can be quite repetitive. The grind can easily weigh people down, but there are enough moments in Dave the Diver's storytelling and the game's overall narrative that it keeps re-energizing you to keep doing it – to unlock and reveal interesting aspects of the game that continue to delight and entertain.

There's no great meaning or higher purpose to accomplish when you play

Dave the Diver. It's a simple, unpretentious game with chill vibes, capable of providing immense joy and satisfaction from undertaking a wide variety of tasks. And if there's one thing you'll never complain about being Dave is not having enough to do. There's so much packed in this game that just surpasses expectations and

delights you to no end, like a super-app with lots of hidden bells and whistles, where exploration meets adventure and constant multitasking aspires towards perfection. I can't recommend this game enough, both for casual gamers and anyone who wants to try something different with a twist. It's definitely the Indie of the Year for me. Anyone who loves and enjoys gaming should give Dave the Diver a try, you will not regret it! *